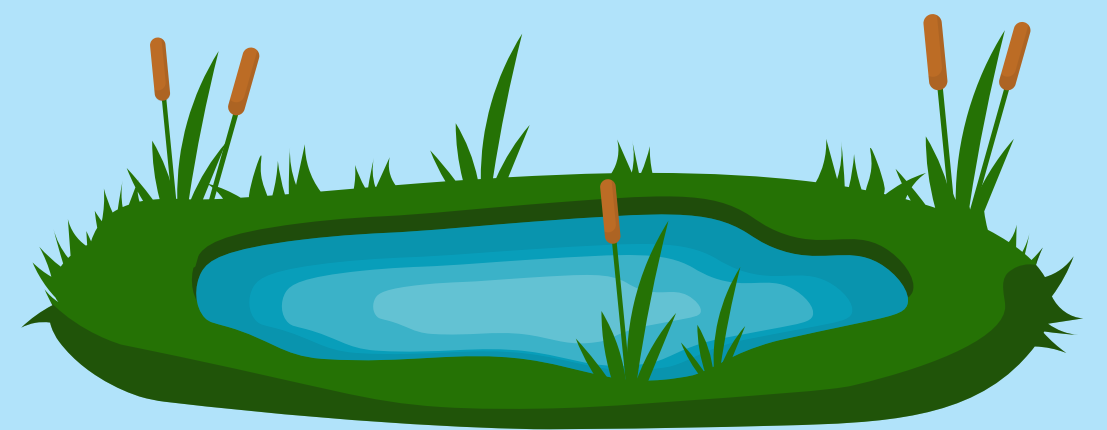


MEET MY FELLA VORTICELLA

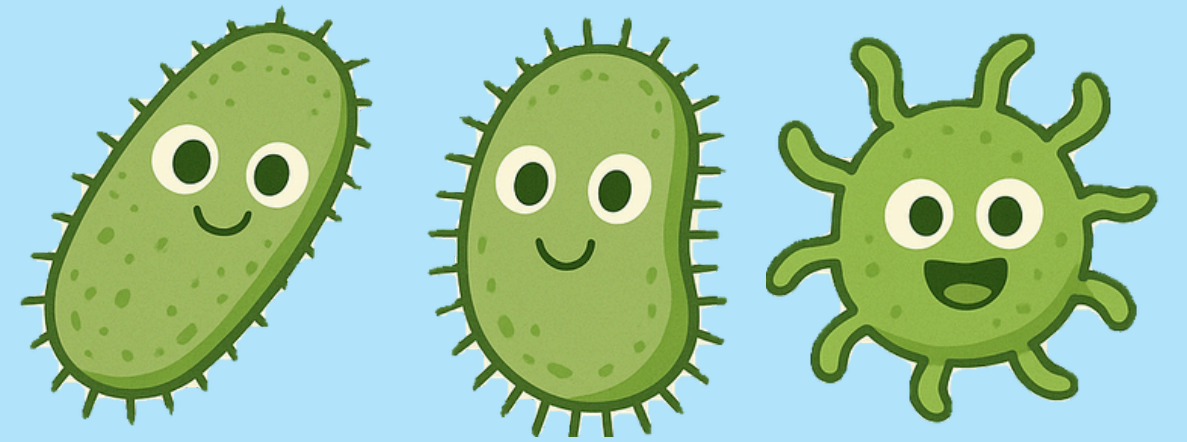
DIVE INTO THE BEATY POND
MY NAME MEANS "LITTLE WHIRLPOOL"

WHERE DOES IT LIVE

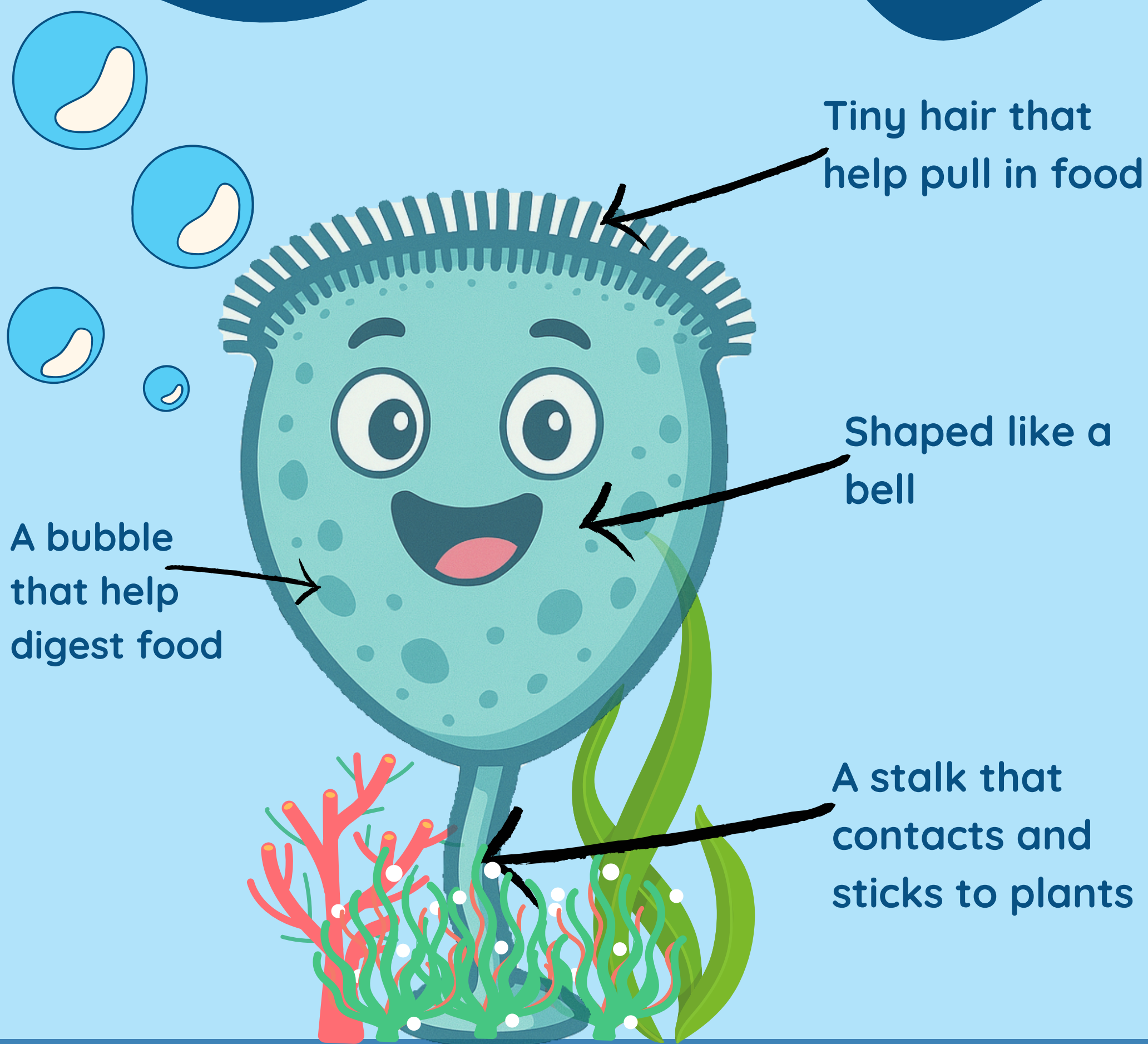
Vorticella live in ponds and love to stick to plants using their stalk



FAVOURITE FOOD

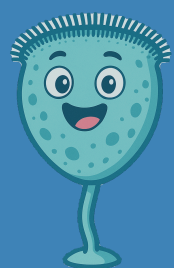


Vorticella love to eat very small bacteria



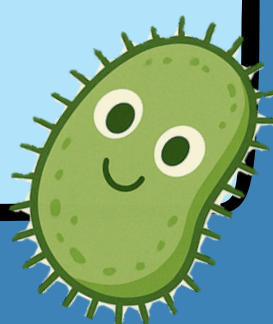
FUN FACTS

Vorticella are twice as small as a grain of sand



Sand Grain

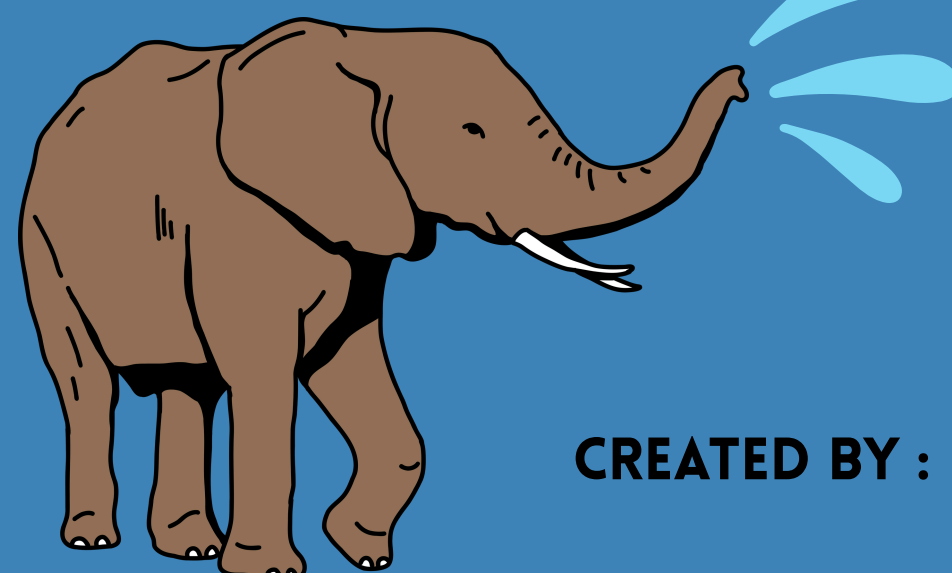
It helps clean ponds by eating bacteria



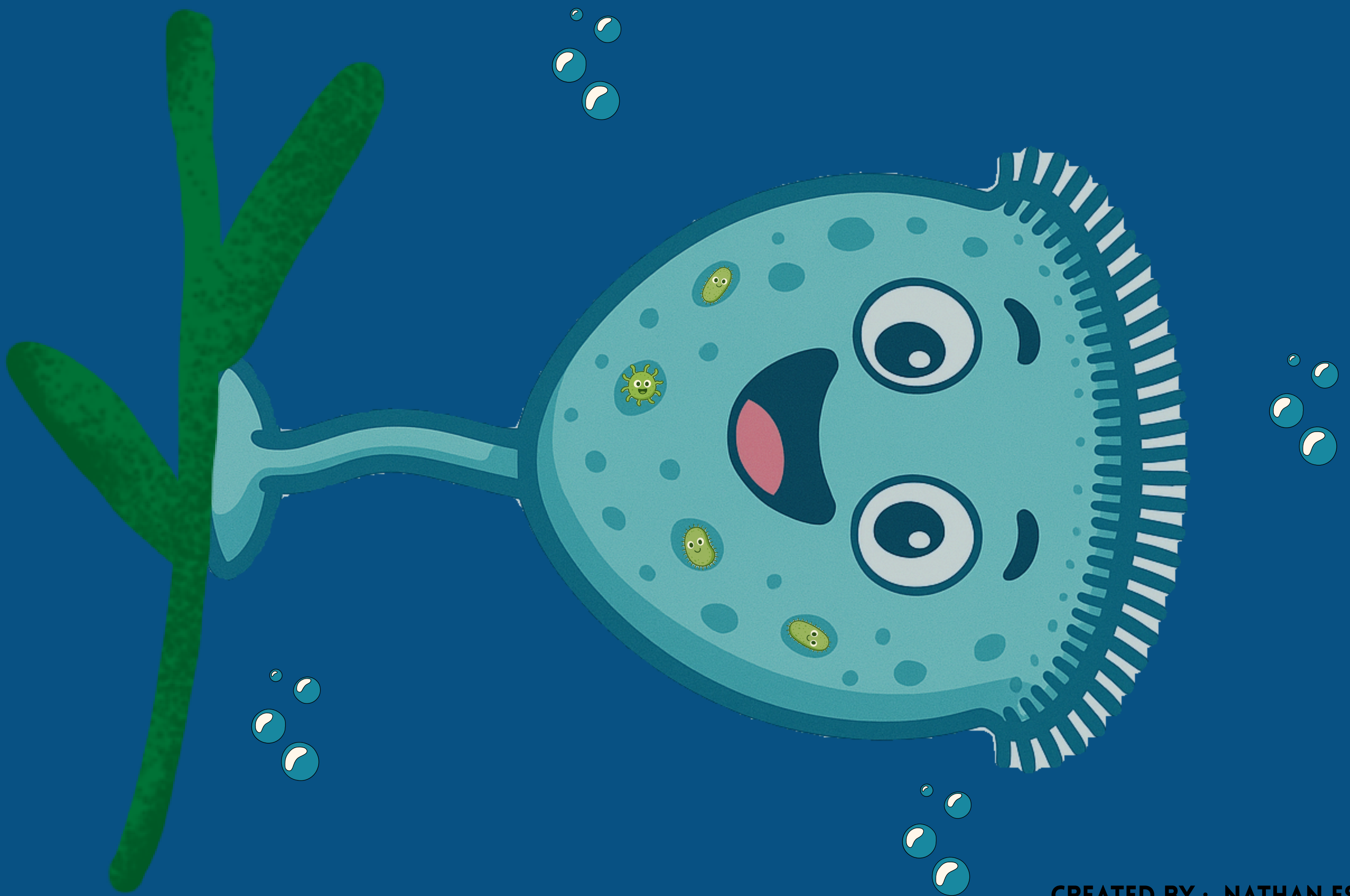
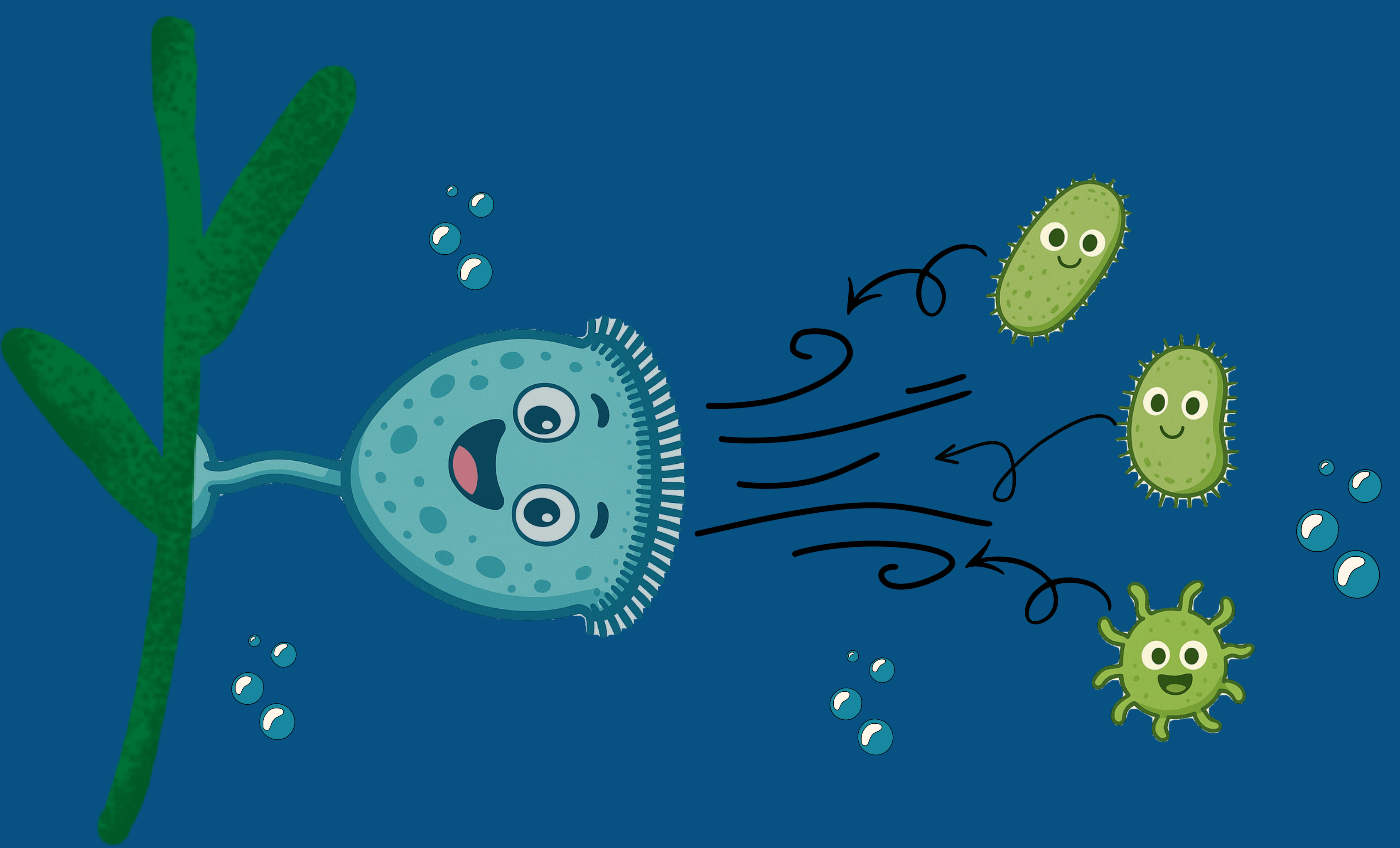
Vorticella have been around for at least 200 million years



Their stalk can pull 30,000 times their body weight. That is equivalent to a human lifting 337 African Elephants

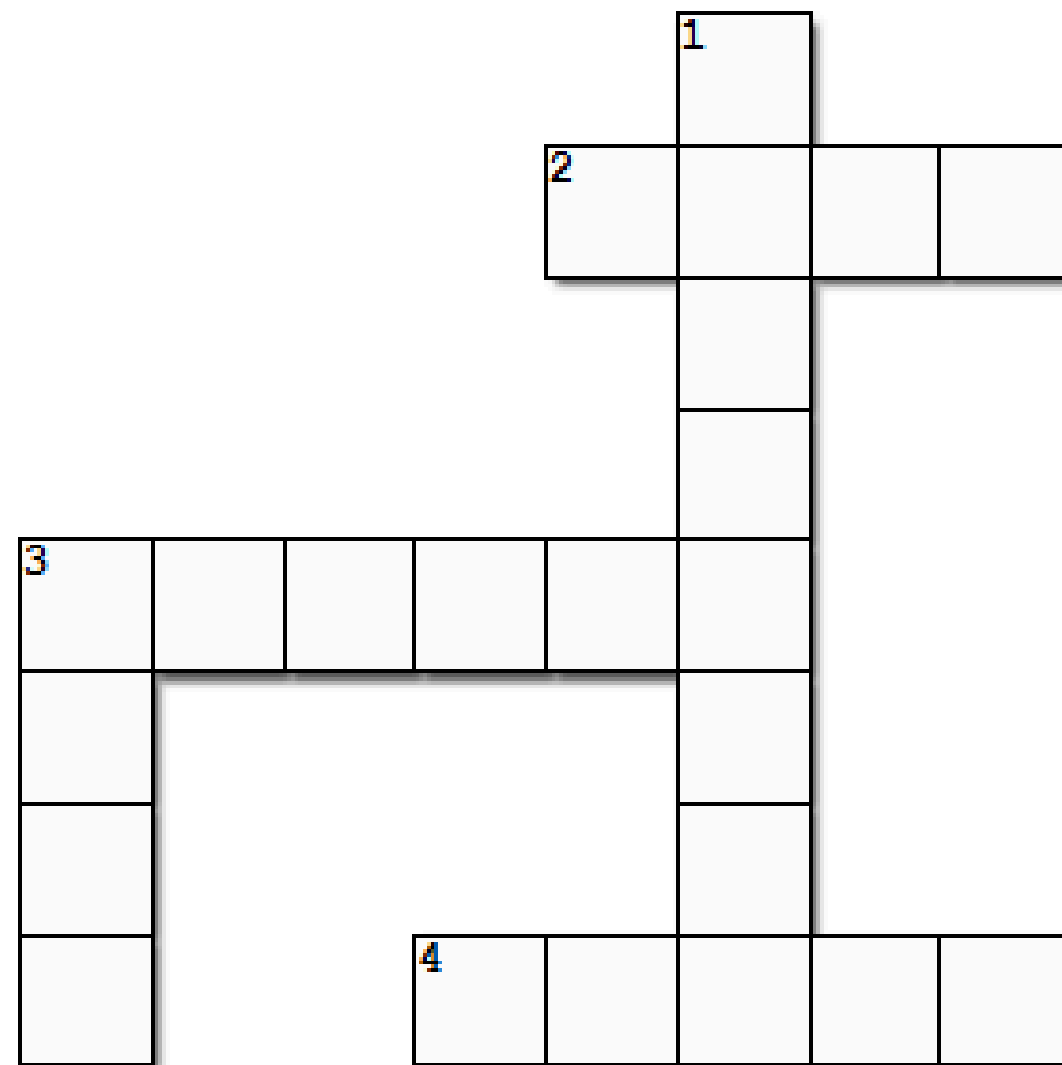


CREATED BY : NATHAN ESTIFANOS



Name: _____

Complete the crossword puzzle below

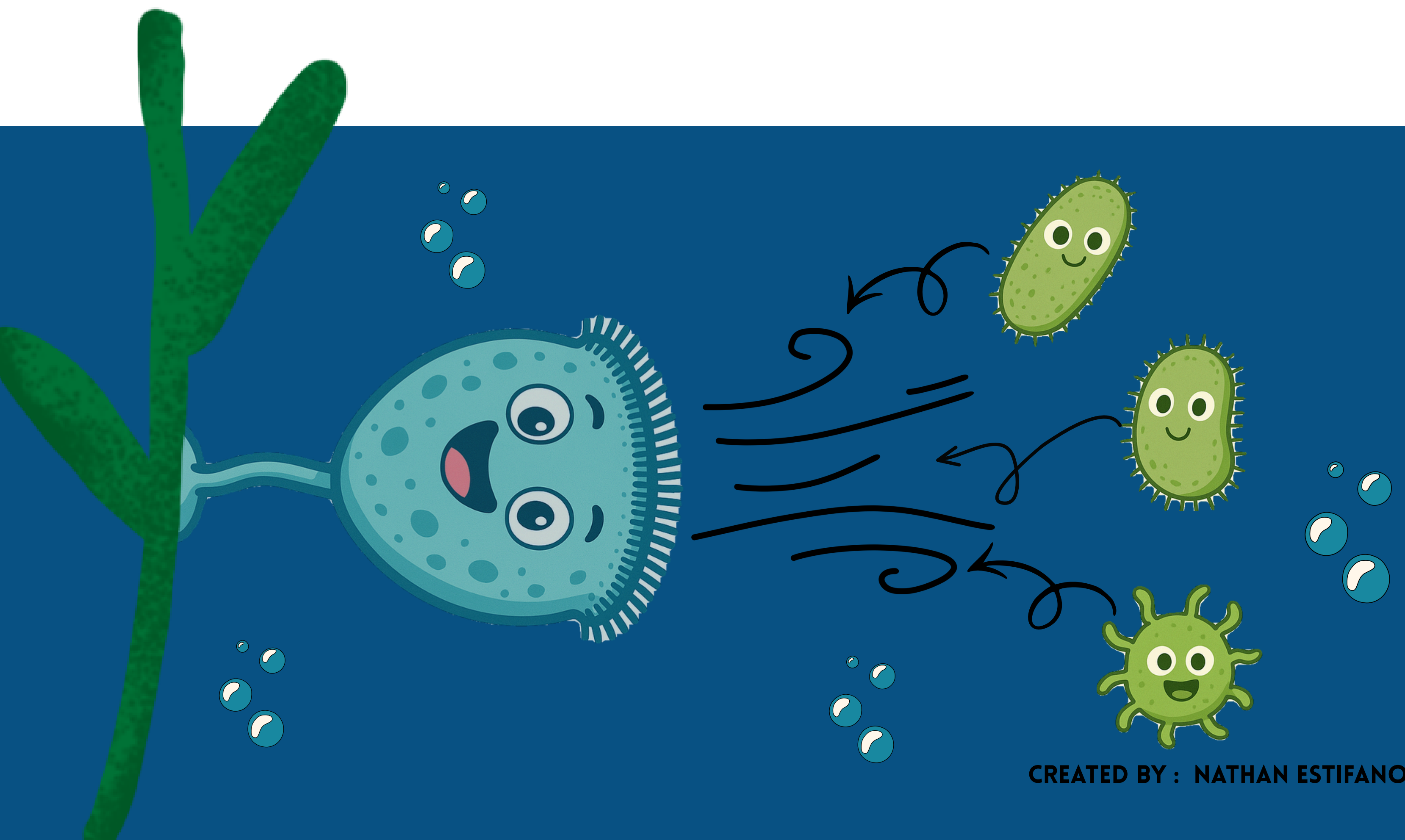


Across

- 2. help pull in food
- 3. helps digest food
- 4. stick to plants

Down

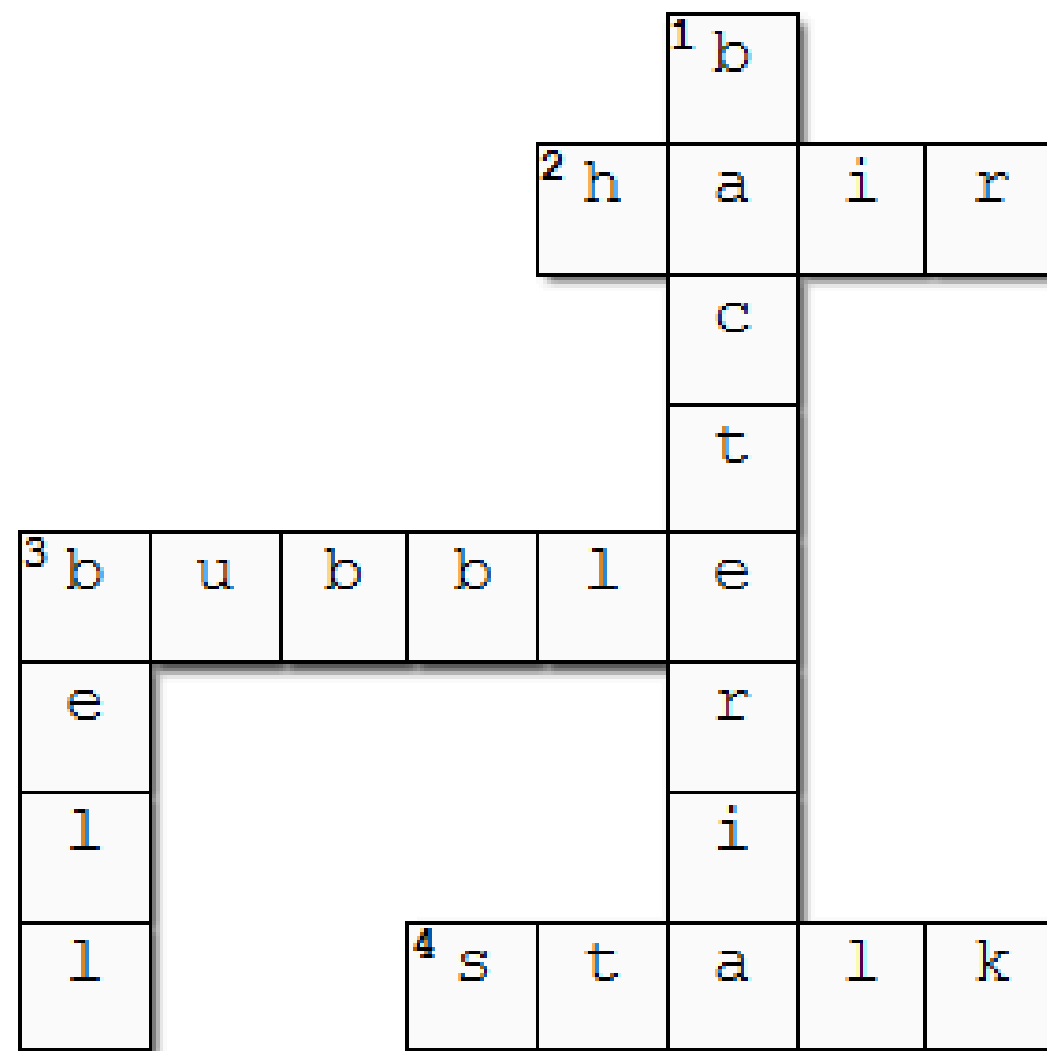
- 1. vorticella's favorite food
- 3. shape of the vorticella



ANSWER KEY

Name: _____

Complete the crossword puzzle below



Across

- 2. help pull in food (**hair**)
- 3. helps digest food (**bubble**)
- 4. stick to plants (**stalk**)

Down

- 1. vorticella's favorite food (**bacteria**)
- 3. shape of the vorticella (**bell**)

HINT 1- Starts with the letter B

HINT 2- rhymes with the word stair

HINT 3- Starts with the letter B

HINT 4- Ends with the letter K

SUMMARY

Vorticella is a **unicellular eukaryotic ciliate** mostly found in freshwater habitats such as ponds, lakes, and slow-moving streams while usually being attached to plants.

The organism has a bell-shaped body mounted on a contractile stalk that anchors it to a surface. This stalk contains a contractile material called the **spasmoneme**, which allows Vorticella to coil rapidly in response to touch or sudden changes in the environment.

Around the open end of the bell are rows of hair-like **cilia** arranged in a circular pattern. These **cilia** beat rapidly to create water currents that draw in bacteria and small organic particles, which are then directed into the cell mouth for feeding.

Because of its clear and unique structure, feeding behavior, and rapid stalk contraction, Vorticella is frequently observed and is one of the most interesting **ciliates**.

DEFINITIONS

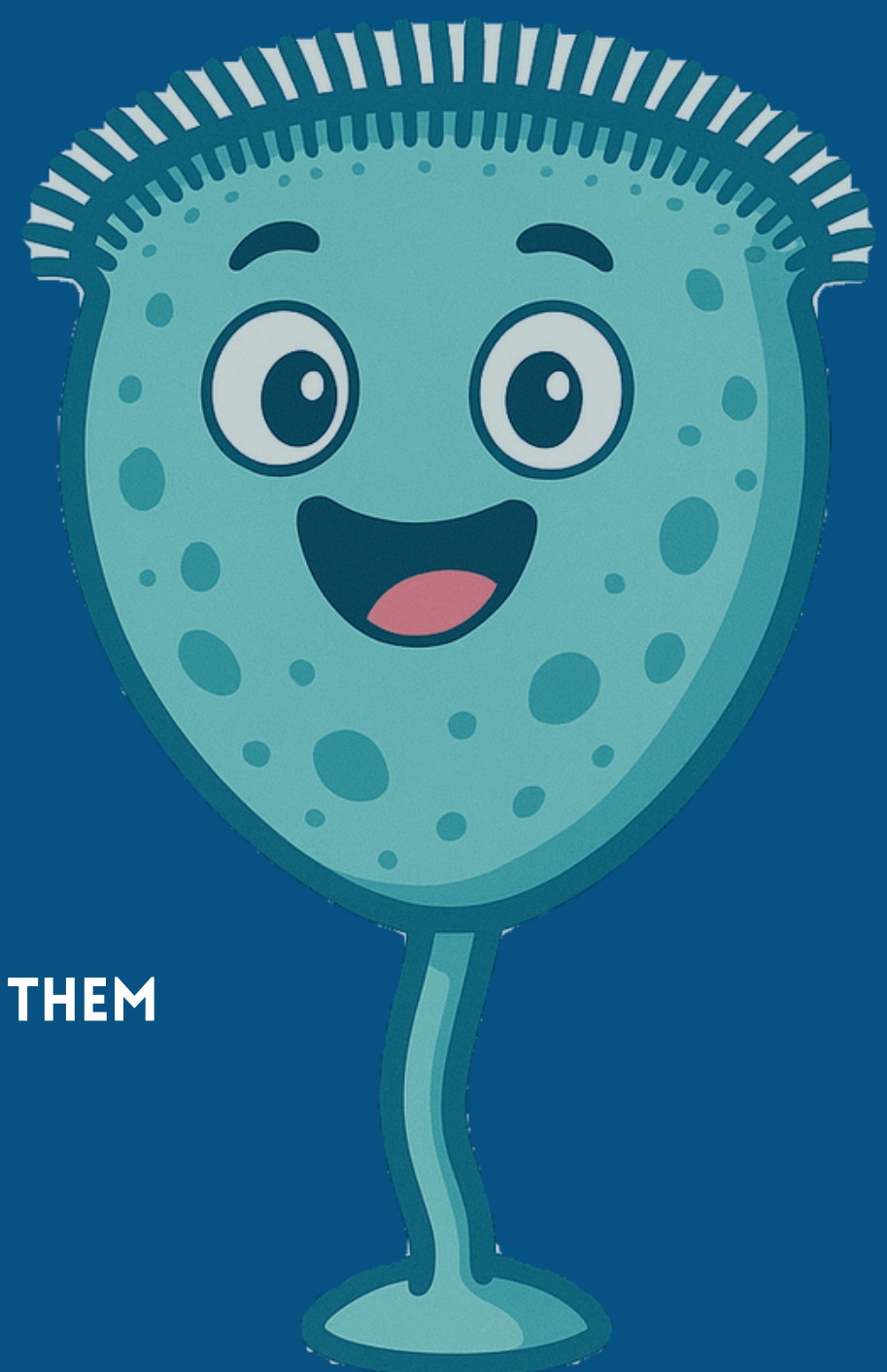
UNICELLULAR – AN ORGANISM COMPOSED OF A SINGLE CELL

EUKARYOTIC – DESCRIBES CELLS THAT CONTAIN A MEMBRANE-BOUND NUCLEUS AND OTHER MEMBRANE-BOUND ORGANELLES.

CILIATE – A TYPE OF ORGANISM THAT IS COVERED WITH CILIA AND USES THEM FOR MOVEMENT AND FEEDING.

CILIA – SHORT, HAIR-LIKE PROJECTIONS ON THE SURFACE OF A CELL

SPASMONEME – A CONTRACTILE PROTEIN STRUCTURE



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